



Can, Could, May

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Quick Reminder

- **Can** → present ability / permission (informal)
- **Could** → past ability / polite requests
- **May** → permission (more formal) / possibility

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks (Mixed Forms)

Complete the sentences with **can**, **could**, or **may**.

1. _____ you help me with my homework? (**interrogative**)
2. She _____ speak three languages fluently. (**affirmative**)
3. _____ I borrow your pen, please? (**interrogative**)
4. They _____ play the guitar when they were younger. (**affirmative**)
5. _____ I go to the bathroom? (**interrogative**)
6. He _____ swim very well. (**affirmative**)
7. You _____ not use my phone without asking. (**negative**)
8. _____ we sit here? (**interrogative**)
9. She _____ run faster than anyone in her class. (**affirmative**)
10. _____ you pass me the salt? (**interrogative**)

Exercise 2: Multiple Choice

Choose the best modal.

1. _____ you help me with this problem?
(a) May (b) Could (c) Can
2. She _____ speak French fluently.
(a) may (b) can (c) could
3. _____ I leave the room for a moment?
(a) Could (b) May (c) Can
4. When he was a child, he _____ ride a bike.
(a) may (b) could (c) can
5. _____ I have a glass of water?
(a) Can (b) May (c) Could
6. They _____ not play the piano when they were young.
(a) can (b) could (c) may
7. _____ you tell me the time?
(a) Can (b) May (c) Could
8. You _____ not smoke here.
(a) can (b) could (c) may
9. She _____ read when she was three years old.
(a) may (b) can (c) could

10. _____ I sit here?
(a) May (b) Can (c) Could

Exercise 3: Forming Sentences (Affirmative, Negative, Interrogative)

Rearrange the words and use the correct modal.

1. (speak / she / can / three / languages) →
_____.
2. (borrow / I / may / your / phone) →
_____?
3. (not / they / could / swim / when / young) →
_____.
4. (help / you / can / me) →
_____?
5. (play / he / could / guitar / the / past) →
_____.
6. (not / you / may / enter / here) →
_____.
7. (run / she / fast / can / very) →
_____?
8. (use / I / can / your / computer) →
_____?
9. (not / he / could / read / when / child) →
_____.
10. (we / may / sit / here) →
_____?

Exercise 4: Travel Context (Mixed Forms)

1. _____ I have a window seat, please?
2. You _____ not smoke on the plane.
3. _____ you help me with my luggage?
4. When I was younger, I _____ speak better English.

5. _____ we leave our bags here for a moment?
6. She _____ speak three languages, so she helps tourists.
7. _____ I use the Wi-Fi in the hotel?
8. He _____ not swim when he was a child.
9. _____ you recommend a good restaurant nearby?
10. We _____ visit the museum tomorrow if we have time.

Exercise 5: Error Correction

Correct the mistakes, if any.

1. May you help me? →
_____?
2. She can spoke three languages. →
_____.
3. Could I to borrow your pen? →
_____?
4. He not could swim when he was young.
→
_____.
5. May I going to the bathroom? →
_____?
6. They could played the guitar very well.
→
_____.
7. Can I to sit here? →
_____?
8. She may not drive when she was 18. →
_____.
9. Could you passing me the salt? →
_____?
10. I can not to use your phone. →
_____.